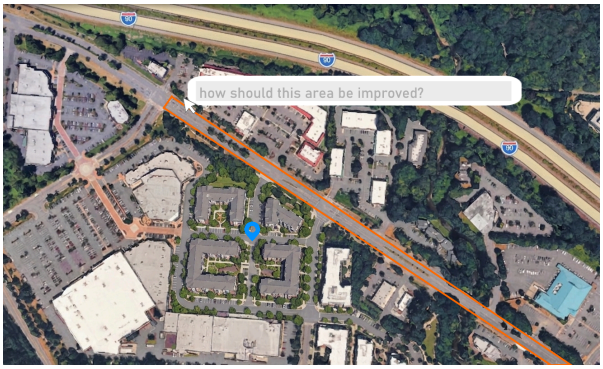
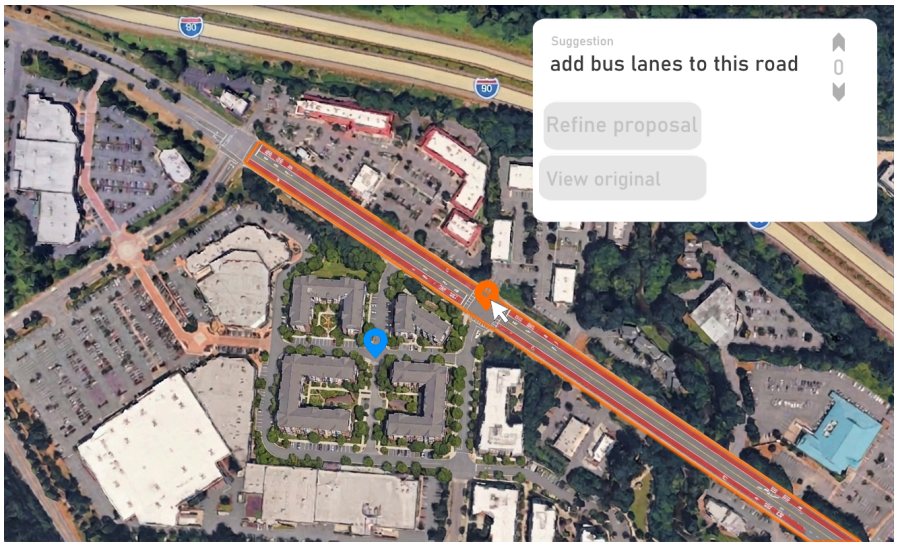
As a former city advocate, it can be difficult to translate the needs and wants of a community into easily digestible ideas for all to comprehend. Typically, the role of converting community ideas into visual output lies with the urban planners & associated city officials. However, the democratization of image generation allows for the community to bring direct visual input instead, providing valuable collaborative discussion on a community's future. I propose a collaborative community design website for urban planners, advocates, and community members to convert targeted ideas into visual edits. The website functions as such: users select a section of satellite imagery, then type out their suggestion as to how they wish to improve it. That suggestion is sent to an image edit model such as Gemini's Nano Banana for image editing. The resulting edits are updated on the map, with a pin indicating a user edit. Other users may choose to upvote/downvote map edits, or suggest new edits that build on top of existing edits. The result is a highly collaborative form of city planning in which each person has the ability to envision, critique, and reimagine the world around them in real-time. Issues that may arise include availability of an image generation model that sufficiently recreates satellite imagery, and inclusion of responsible guardrails so as to exclude out-of-scope prompting.



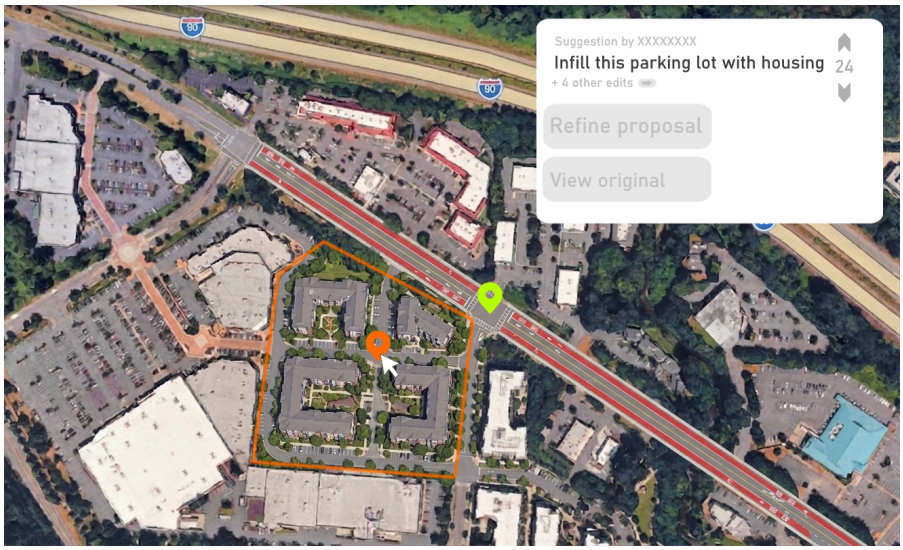


The user highlights a section they wish to improve, then types out their prompt.

Once generated, edits to the map appear as pins. Edit details can be seen by selecting a pin.



Another user’s edit is highlighted here. Edits can be upvoted or downvoted by others. Editing history can also be expanded and viewed here to gain a full understanding of varying community visions for the highlighted area.



Generative AI Disclosure: Satellite imagery in the following examples were modified using Gemini’s Nano Banana for demonstration purposes.